

Intermediate Microeconomics
ECO 3301 002
Economics Department
Fall 2026



Instructor Information

Instructor: Fernanda Da Silva
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Office Location: ULEE 240
Office Hours:
Monday-Tuesday: 4:00-5:30PM

Course Details

Meeting Days/Times/Locations:

Start Date	End Date	Location	Meeting Day	Start Time	End Time
08/24/2026	12/08/2026	FOSC0153	MWF	02:00 PM	02:50 PM

Credit Hours: 3.00

Course Description: Building on topics covered in ECO 1311, this course considers problems of microeconomics that are more advanced, with a focus on understanding how consumers behave, firms make pricing and output decisions, and market structure impacts the behavior of firms and consumers. Prerequisites: C- or better in the following: ECO 1311; ECO 1312; and MATH 1309, MATH 1337 or MATH 1408.

Student Learning Outcomes

Course Description

This is an intermediate course in microeconomics. The main goal of the course is to introduce the core models of microeconomics. In doing this, we will learn:

- how to model consumer choices
- how to model firm pricing and output decisions

- the interaction of consumers and firms in markets
- market structures and market failures

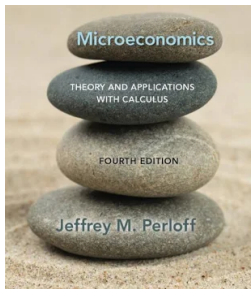
The course is designed to provide a strong foundation in the tools that underlie economic analysis, including the models used in many upper-level courses you will take. We will analyze economic situations using graphs, mathematics, and intuitive approaches. The material can be difficult and time-consuming, and a good way to succeed is to PRACTICE.

Course Goals

At the end of the course, students will demonstrate knowledge of intermediate microeconomic models. Specifically, students will be able to:

- discuss and explain economic concepts using graphical and mathematical representations
- solve consumer theory problems and understand how they apply to real-world scenarios
- apply producer theory to explain firm behavior
- use analytical tools to predict pricing and production outcomes under different market structures

Required Texts and Materials



Microeconomics: Theory and Applications with Calculus

ISBN: 9780134483368

Authors: Jeffrey M. Perloff

Publisher: Prentice Hall

Publication Date: 2016-03-15

Edition: 4th or 5th

** You can use the 4th or 5th edition. Be sure to get version with Calculus. The digital edition is fine. The ISBN for the most recent edition is ISBN-13: 9780135640432

Grading Policies/Grading Scale

The following weights are the basis for your final grade, but the grade can also be affected by attendance and in-class participation.

Attendance/ participation	5%
Quizzes and In-Class Exercises	10%

Problem Sets	10%
Midterm 1	25%
Midterm 2	25%
Final Exam	25%-50% (see policy below)
Bonus	Up to 2% (core exam)

Final grades will be based on this scale:

Grade	Minimum Score
A	93
A-	90
B+	87
B	83
B-	80
C+	77
C	73
C-	70
D+	67
D	63
D-	60

General Expectations and Principles

To complete this class, I expect that students will attend and participate in each class, submit assignments on time, and sit for the exams at the scheduled time.

Life events and emergencies sometimes interfere. To cover these situations, there is automatic flexibility built into the grades for attendance, assignments, and midterms through free absences, dropped assignments, and a replacement policy for up to one midterm (not the final exam, though). This automatic flexibility, which is detailed below, avoids the need for you to provide documentation and the need for me to verify the events. Almost all situations will be covered by this automatic flexibility, but if your situation is truly exceptional, please reach out to me.

Attendance/participation

Attendance/participation determines 5% of your grade. Excused absences, which do not count against the attendance grade, are those under the University policies: religious events, athletics, and documented serious illnesses and medical procedures requiring extended absences (e.g., a multi-week hospitalization). Students experiencing a serious illness or procedure should contact the Office of the Dean of Students, which will help students decide how to deal with the interruption to their studies.

Flexibility: You each have three free absences. These free absences are meant to cover illnesses, travel conflicts, traffic accidents, personal issues, etc. Regular illnesses such as colds, the flu, or strep are covered by this policy. You do not need to email me about these events.

Additional absences beyond three freebies count against the 5% attendance grade. The final attendance grade will be based on the number of additional absences. (Note, this adjustment will not be visible in the Canvas gradebook.)

In exceptional cases requiring more than three absences from legitimate, documented sicknesses, further accommodations are possible. Please talk with me if this applies to you.

Grading: Attendance is tracked in "Qwickly Attendance" following SMU policy. You begin with 5 attendance points, and each absence (after the three free absences) subtracts 0.5 points from this total. Canvas's automatic grading does not integrate with Qwickly, so your real-time attendance grade in Canvas does not reflect your attendance grade. I will adjust grades at the end of the semester to include the attendance grade.

Quizzes and In-Class Exercises

10% of your grade comes from short Canvas quizzes and in-class exercises/labs. Use Chrome or Firefox when taking Canvas quizzes because Safari has errors when showing images.

Problem sets

The written homework assignments count for 10% of your grade. These homework assignments are one of the best methods to learn the material and prepare for exams. You are allowed (and encouraged) to work on these assignments in groups, but each individual must submit his or her own handwritten assignment.

Write answers clearly and in an organized way. **Draw a box around your final answers for each question.** Points will be taken off if illegible, disorganized, or final answers are not boxed. Problem sets will be submitted as .pdfs through Canvas. See below for ways to convert documents to .pdfs.

Late assignments are not accepted, including for technical reasons.

Flexibility: the lowest problem set grade will be dropped.

Exams

Midterms

There will be two non-cumulative midterms, each worth 25% of your final grade. The dates are available on Canvas. All exams must be taken at the scheduled time in class.

Alternative times and make-up exams are not available.

Students with DASS accommodations are responsible for scheduling their exam time with the University Testing Center. I strongly suggest signing up for your time within the first two weeks of the semester, because there are limited slots available.

Basic or Scientific Calculators are allowed on the exams, but no graphing calculators.

Flexibility: one midterm grade can be replaced with the final exam grade, if the final exam grade is higher. This replacement option has two purposes. First, occasionally, a student may have an emergency or sickness that conflicts with the timing of the midterm. If a student misses one midterm for any reason, the solution is to replace that missed exam with the final exam grade. Second, students can improve their understanding of the material through the semester and demonstrate this understanding on the final exam.

Limitations:

- A student can miss, at most, one midterm. If a student misses a second exam, a 0% will be recorded for that midterm grade.
- All students must take the final exam at the University-assigned time. Missing the final exam results in a grade of 0% for the final.

The class is cumulative and, from prior experience, it is difficult to stay up-to-date with the material if a student does not prepare for midterm 1 and midterm 2.

Final Exam

There is a final exam, worth (at least) 25%, which is cumulative, with half covering recent material and half covering material covered in sections 1 and 2. Any material covered in class, on the homework, or in the reading can be covered on the exams.

Replacement policy: In addition to the regular 25% weight, the final exam grade can replace one of the two midterm grades.

Examples:

- A student earns 65% on midterm 1, 80% on midterm 2, and 90% on the final exam. The final exam grade will replace midterm 1, so the course grade will be based on test grades of 90%, 80%, 90%.
- A student earns 70% on midterm 1, misses midterm 2 for illness, and earns an 85% on the final exam. The final exam grade will replace midterm 2, so the course grade will be based on test grades of 70%, 85%, 85%.
- A student earns 85% on midterm 1, 85% on midterm 2, and 70% on the final exam. No replacement. The course grade will be based on test grades of 85%, 85%, 70%.

All students must take the final exam at the University-assigned time. There are no make-ups or alternative test times. Please mark this on your calendar.

Grading questions and challenges

If you have any questions about midterm or homework grading, you have two weeks from the date the midterm/assignment is returned to talk with me. After that period, no grade changes will be made.

.pdf conversion

In order to turn in written homework assignments, you will need either a scanner or an app that will scan multiple pages into a .pdf. Some apps that can convert photos to a PDF include Office Lens, Adobe Scan, and Tiny Scanner, Notes (iOS).

Our Contract

The syllabus is an important document if you remain in this course. Continued enrollment in this course indicates agreement with all stipulations laid out in this document. Any future discussions between you and me assume your agreement with this syllabus.

Credit Hours by Activity

SMU defines a credit hour as the amount of work represented in the achievement of student learning outcomes that reasonably approximates one hour (50 minutes) of

instruction and a minimum of two hours of out-of-class student work per week for each credit hour. The table below calculates estimates of this time investment.

Academic Activity	# of Acti...	X	Hours	Total Activity ...
In Class Instruction	15 weeks	X	3	45
Problem Sets	9	X	3	27
Quizzes	16	X	1	16
Final Exam	1	X	3	3
Textbook readings	15 weeks	X	3	45
All Activities		X	Total Estimated Hours	136

Course Policies

Recommendation letters

If you think you may need a recommendation letter, I would suggest that you perform well in the class, contribute to the class discussion, and stop by office hours at least once. All of these things enable professors to write you a stronger letter.

Caveat

This syllabus is subject to change. Any changes will be communicated to students in Canvas announcements and/or in class. Students who miss class are responsible for learning about any changes to the syllabus.

Generative AI Policy

Generative AI may be used with appropriate attribution. You may use Generative AI tools

for productivity in this course. When using Generative AI, follow these parameters:

* Take responsibility for the content (e.g., written and digital/interactive media assignments and project). AI can produce content that contains inaccurate information, offensive language/images, and biased or unethical representations. What you submit is your responsibility across these dimensions.

** Provide clear attribution of your sources. Any assignments that utilize Generative AI without attribution per the guidelines shared in this course can be seen as potential academic dishonesty and treated at the undergraduate level within the SMU Student Honor Code and at the graduate and professional level within the honor codes found in their respective school policies.

Title IX and Disability Accommodations

Disability Accommodations

Students who need academic accommodations for a disability must first register with Disability Accommodations & Success Strategies (DASS). Students can call 214-768-1470 or visit smu.edu/DASS to begin the process. Once they are registered and approved, students then submit a DASS Accommodation Letter through the electronic portal, [DASS Link](#), and then communicate directly with each of their instructors to make appropriate arrangements. Please note that accommodations are not retroactive, but rather require advance notice in order to implement.

Sexual Harassment

All forms of sexual harassment, including sexual assault, dating violence, domestic violence and stalking, are violations of SMU's Title IX Sexual Harassment Policy and may also violate Texas law. Students who wish to file a complaint or to receive more information about the grievance process may contact Samantha Thomas, SMU's Title IX Coordinator, at accessequity@smu.edu or 214-768-3601. Please note that faculty and staff are mandatory reporters. If students notify faculty or staff of sexual harassment, they must report it to the Title IX Coordinator. For more information about sexual harassment, including resources available to assist students, please visit smu.edu/sexualharassment.

Pregnant Students

Students who are pregnant may request academic adjustments or work accommodations

by contacting the Office of Student Advocacy and Support by calling 214-768-4564. Students seeking assistance must schedule an appointment with their professors as early as possible, present a letter from the Office of the Dean of Students, and make appropriate arrangements. Please note that academic adjustments are not retroactive and, when feasible, require advance notice to implement.

Academic Policies

Religious Observance

Religiously observant students wishing to be absent on holidays that require missing class should notify their professors in writing within the first two weeks of the semester and should discuss with them, in advance, acceptable ways of making up any work missed because of the absence. [Click here for a list of holidays.](#)

Medical-Related Absences

To ensure academic continuity and avoid any course penalties, students should follow procedures described by their instructors in order to be provided with appropriate modifications to assignments, deadlines, and exams.

Excused Absences for University Extracurricular Activities

Students participating in an officially sanctioned, scheduled university extracurricular activity should be given the opportunity to make up class assignments or other graded assignments that were missed as a result of their participation. It is the responsibility of the student to make arrangements for make-up work with the instructor prior to any missed scheduled examinations or other missed assignments. (See current [Catalog](#) under heading of "Academic Records/Excused Absences.")

Final Exams

Final course examinations shall be given in all courses where appropriate, and some form of final assessment is essential. Final exams and assessments must be administered as specified in the official examination schedule and cannot be administered or due during the last week of classes or during the Reading Period. Syllabi must state clearly the form of the final exam or assessment, and the due date and time must match the official SMU exam schedule. SMU policy states that all exceptions to the examination schedule may be

made only upon written recommendation of the chair of the department sponsoring the course and with the concurrence of the dean of that school, who will allow exceptions only in accordance with guidelines from the Office of the Provost.

Academic Dishonesty

Students are expected to embrace and uphold the [SMU Honor Code](#). Violations of the Honor Code will be acted upon in accordance with the policies and procedures outlined in the [Mustang Student Handbook](#).

Generative AI Guidance

Every course must have a statement about classroom guidance around Generative AI. This [syllabus statement builder](#) has been provided to generate course-specific guidelines.

Zoom Use Guidelines

SACSCOC and university policy require that all in-person classes be taught in person and not moved to Zoom or other technology-mediated modalities, except for [extenuating circumstances as laid out here](#).

Recording of Classes

Unauthorized student recording is prohibited. A full description of this policy can be found in [SMU Policy 2.27 Audio/Video Recording in Academic Settings](#). Students who have approved accommodations for recording through the Disability Accommodations and Success Strategies (DASS) office do not need separate permission from the instructor to use those accommodations. Students are expected to communicate with their instructor early in the semester regarding how these accommodations will be implemented. Otherwise, all other uses of technologies for audio/video recording of lectures and other classroom activities are allowed only with the express prior permission of the instructor. This policy does not prohibit the use of SMU-approved instructional technologies to record class sessions for legitimate educational purposes when such recordings are authorized by the instructor and managed through institutionally supported technology systems, subject to applicable retention, access, and FERPA requirements. In cases where such recordings are allowed, content is restricted to Personal Use only, as defined in Policy Number 2.27, and the recording must not be shared beyond the class members without the written consent of all instructors and attendees who were recorded and must not be saved by students beyond the duration of the term.

Inclement Weather and Emergency Operations

In the event that SMU cancels classes due to inclement weather, we ask that you reference the [following guidelines for further information](#).

Credit Hour Policy

In accordance with federal policy and SACSCOC standards, SMU defines a credit hour as the amount of work represented in the achievement of student learning outcomes that reasonably approximates one hour (50 minutes) of instruction and a minimum of two hours of out-of-class student work per week for each credit hour. Students should expect to spend at least three hours per week engaged in course-related work for each credit hour. Important Note: Shortened time frames (e.g., mod classes, intersessions classes, etc.) do not reduce total contact hour and expectations of time in student work outside of class. The same total hours must be delivered in a shorter timeframe through longer meetings or more intensive assignments. The following calculations hold true as a reflection of credit, regardless of the format of course delivery and include, but are not exhaustive of, the following: regular-term in-person; online/hybrid; laboratory; studio; internship/practicum /field experience; intersession/compressed term/course modules (A/B).

Student Support Services

Student Advising and Academic Success

Students needing assistance with writing assignments for SMU courses may schedule an appointment with the Writing Center through [Writing Center Online](#). Students who would like support for subject-specific tutoring should access the [tutor schedule](#). Students can schedule individual [academic counseling sessions](#) and attend [learning strategies workshops](#) on a variety of skills. This academic support is located on the 4th floor of the Blanton Student Services Building; 214-768-3648; smu.edu/a-lec and smu.edu/asd

Caring Community Connections Program

CCC is a resource for anyone in the SMU community to refer students of concern to the Office of the Dean of Students. The online referral form can be found at smu.edu/deanofstudentsccc. After a referral form is submitted, students will be contacted to discuss the concern, strategize options, and be connected to appropriate resources. Anyone who is unclear about what steps to take if they have concerns about students

should contact the Office of the Dean of Students at 214-768-4564.

Mental Health Resources: Counseling Services and Teletherapy

Throughout the academic year, students may encounter different stressors or go through life experiences which impact their mental health and academic performance. Students who are in distress or have concerns about their mental health can schedule a same-day or next-day appointment to speak with a counselor by calling [Counseling Services](#). Counselors are available at any time, day or night for students in crisis at this number: 214-768-2277 (then select option 2) They will be connected with a counselor immediately. Students seeking ongoing counseling should call the same number (214-768-2277, then select option 1) during normal business hours to schedule an initial appointment. [SMU Teletherapy](#) provides another free option for on-demand counseling and video appointments with a medical professional.

Campus Carry Law

In accordance with Texas Senate Bill 11, also known as the 'campus carry' law, and following consultation with entire University community, SMU chooses to remain a weapons-free campus. Specifically, SMU prohibits possession of weapons (either openly or in a concealed manner) on campus. For more information, please see: smu.edu/campuscarrylaw.

Course Schedule

Schedule of Topics

Topic
Logistics, intro, math review, supply and demand (Ch. 1-2)
Supply and demand (Ch. 2)
Consumer preferences, utility functions, indifference curves (Ch. 3)
Demand curves, comparative statics of demand, income and substitution effects (Ch. 4)
Consumer welfare and policy analysis (Ch.5)
Midterm 1
Producer theory, production functions, and cost curves (Ch.6-7)
Profit maximization, supply curves (Ch. 8)
Competition and analysis of competitive markets (Ch. 9)
Midterm 2
Monopoly (Ch. 11)
Game theory, Oligopoly (Ch. 13, Ch.14)
Externalities and public goods (Ch. 17)

Attendance via Qwickly App

This course will use the Qwickly Attendance tool to record student attendance. You will be required to download and use the free Qwickly mobile app on your smartphone via [Google Play](#) or the [Apple App Store](#). At the beginning of each class session, you will be prompted to check in using the app. Your attendance record, as captured through Qwickly, will be used in accordance with the course's attendance policy. Please ensure your device is charged and the app is installed prior to our first class meeting.